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TRANSPORTATION



TechCrunch Mobility:
Tesla vs GM: A tale of two
earnings

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On that note, GM's new strategy is clear: It's all about EVs. GM's CEO, Tim Cullen, said the company is "facing a market that has seen growth slow while facing a future without EV incentives."

How GM and Tesla plan to navigate this (or at least what they're signaling) is quite different.

GM, which saw tariffs take a \$1 billion bite out of its Q2 line, still sees EVs as its "north star." And while GM certainly trails Tesla in EV sales today, it has a bigger mix of EV models to attract customers — more than a dozen in all. And Chevrolet is now the No. 2 EV brand in the U.S.

And while GM did tout \$4 billion of deferred revenue from its advanced driver-assistance system Super

- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion

Cruise, along with OnStar and other software services that will be recognized over time, the big theme of the call was “flexibility.”

Chair and CEO Mary Barra and CFO Paul Jacobson said the word “flexibility” nine times during the Q2 earnings call. What they mean by flexibility is setting up factories where they can easily assemble EVs and ICE vehicles — and change up the mix based on demand.

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Meanwhile, Tesla is betting heavily on the “future,” and for CEO Elon Musk that means autonomy and AI, or as he sometimes calls it, “real-world AI.”

The vast majority (about 74%) of Tesla’s revenue still comes from selling cars, [although Q2 results](#) show a 16% year-over-year decline in automotive revenue. But if you listened to the Q2 call, it’s clear that Elon Musk isn’t interested in Tesla being a car company. (He even admitted that the highly anticipated breakthrough cheaper model Tesla is working on is really just a stripped down version of the Model Y.)

Musk wants to make and sell Optimus robots and deploy autonomous vehicles. The problem is that today these products — or future products — are not generating profits, let alone revenue.

Yes, Tesla does bring in revenue from its advanced driver-assistance system known as supervised Full Self-Driving. (This is not an autonomous vehicle and requires human driver engagement.) And yes, the company is charging for robotaxi rides in South Austin, but it is not at scale, nor is it profitable.

Musk acknowledged there would be some rough quarters ahead, but he still believes that ultimately this will be where the bulk of Tesla profits come from.

I think that's more than Musk's current information. Its Optimus compar instance version weeken the requ workar

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Meanwhile, Tesla is under regulatory and legal pressures that could further undermine its effort to reboot sales and even threaten his future plans around FSD.

A little bird



IMAGE CREDITS: BRYCE DURBIN

Got a tip for us? Email [kirsten.korosec](mailto:kirsten.korosec@techcrunch.com) or my Signal at kkorosec.07, Sean O’Kane at sean.okane@techcrunch.com, or Rebecca Bellan at rebecca.bellan@techcrunch.com.

Deals!



IMAGE CREDITS: BRYCE DURBIN

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Startup **Glīd Technologies** [raised \\$3.1 million](#) in a pre-seed funding round led by Outlander VC, with participation from Draper U Ventures, Antler, The Veteran Fund, M1C, and angel investors.

Los Angeles-based **Nevoja** came out of stealth last year with the ambitious goal of breaking the EV truck adoption logjam. Nevoja made enough progress on its goal to attract investors — and a [\\$9.3 million seed round](#) led by Lowercarbon. Floating Point and LMNT Ventures also joined, along with existing investors Third Sphere, Stepchange, and Never Lift. Qasar Younis, the founder and CEO of

buzzy self-driving AI company Applied Intuition also invested.

Rune Technologies, a startup that wants to tackle AI-enabled software for military logistics, raised a \$24 million Series A round led by Human Capital with participation from Pax VC, Washington Harbour Partners, a16z, Point72 Ventures, XYZ Venture Capital, and Forward Deployed VC.

Swift Navigation, which has developed centimeter-accurate positioning for vehicle autonomy, robotics, and logistics, raised \$50 million in a Series E financing round led by Crosslink Capital. Existing investors NEA, Eclipse Ventures, EPIQ Capital

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and Pot
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Capital,
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IMAGE CREDITS: BRYCE DURBIN

Autonomous vehicles

Lyft will add autonomous shuttles made by Austrian manufacturer Benteler Group to its network in late 2026. The shuttles will be deployed in partnership with U.S. cities and airports.

Electric vehicles

Lucid Air owners will be able to charge their luxury EVs at thousands of Tesla Supercharger stations in

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North America starting July 31, nearly two years since the automakers reached an agreement. But there is a [notable caveat](#): Lucid Air vehicles won't be able to charge as fast as Tesla vehicles.

Gig economy

Uber is bringing its [women preferences feature](#), which lets female drivers and riders match with each other, to the United States. The feature will first roll out in Detroit, Los Angeles, and San Francisco.

Last but not least

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IMAGE CREDITS: TESLA

Tesla has enabled the in-car camera in its Model 3 and Model Y vehicles to monitor drivers when its Autopilot advanced driver assistance system is being used.

In a software update, Tesla indicated the “cabin camera above the rearview mirror can now detect and alert driver inattentiveness while Autopilot is engaged.” Notably, Tesla has a closed loop system

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for the data, meaning imagery captured by the camera does not leave the car. The system cannot save or transit information unless data sharing is

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follow distance, hard cap at 75, requires auto
brights or kicks out of AP, cabin camera for driver
monitoring.. nothing unexpected yet.

pic.twitter.com/gKikHSGNI7

— Kevin Smith (@spleck) [May 27, 2021](#)



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Increased in price and capability, has been available as an option for years.

However, Tesla vehicles are not self-driving. FSD includes the parking feature Summon as well as Navigate on Autopilot, an active guidance system that navigates a car from a highway on-ramp to off-ramp, including interchanges and making lane changes. Once drivers enter a destination into the navigation system, they can enable “Navigate on Autopilot” for that trip.

The move comes just a week after Tesla tweeted that its Model Y and Model 3 vehicles bound for North American customers are being built without

radar, full camera support

Automated and can sensing assist control, surround automa potential which o

processing to detect and understand what is happening in the environment surrounding the vehicle and then respond appropriately.

The decision to pull radar out of the vehicles has caused some blowback for the company. Consumer Reports no longer lists the Model 3 as a Top Pick and the Insurance Institute for Highway Safety said it plans to remove the Model 3’s Top Safety Pick+ designation. The National Highway Traffic and Safety Administration has said that Model 3 and Model Y vehicles built on or after April 27, 2021 will no longer receive the agency’s check mark for automatic emergency braking, forward collision

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warning, lane departure warning and dynamic
brake support.

Tesla's decision to scrap its PR department could
create a PR nightmare

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Musk says Tesla aspires
to mass produce
robotaxis by 2024

Rebecca Bellan, Kirsten Korosec

4:39 PM PDT · April 20, 2022

Tesla plans to bring a medical robotaxi with no steering wheel or pedals to market by 2024, CEO Elon Musk said Wednesday during [Tesla's first quarter 2022 earnings call](#).

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number of other innovations around it that he thinks are quite exciting.

"I think can be very powerful product where we aspire to reach volume production in 2024," Musk said later adding "I think [the robotaxi] really will be a massive driver of Tesla's growth."

Earlier this month at [Tesla's Austin gigafactory opening](#), Musk outlined a variety of future products that are a departure from its passenger car business, which generates the bulk of its profits today. Those products included mention of a

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Foxconn sells former GM factory to mystery buyer after failing to make EVs

Sean O'Kane - 3 days ago

robotaxi and Optimus, Tesla's humanoid robot concept.

Tesla's robotaxi pursuit puts it in competition with companies that have been developing autonomous vehicle technology for robotaxis for years, including the Alphabet unit Waymo, Argo AI, Aurora, GM's self-driving subsidiary Cruise, Motional and Zoox.

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It also calls into question whether Tesla intends to scrap its current strategy to full autonomy or if this will be developed in parallel.

Musk has been hinting at robotaxis for years, but not through a standalone product like the one he described Wednesday. Instead, he has repeatedly promised to turn the Tesla vehicles that people own today into their own robotaxi via an upgraded advanced driving assistance system called Full Self-Driving software that currently costs \$12,000.

Tesla vehicles come standard with a driver-assistance system branded as Autopilot. Owners

can buy “full self-driving,” or FSD — software that Musk has repeatedly promised will one day deliver full autonomous driving capabilities. FSD is not capable of driving on its own. It is considered a Level 2 ADAS and still requires a human driver to pay attention and take control. Dozens of videos posted by owners provide a mixed picture of the software’s capability and includes numerous clips of the vehicles failing to navigate basic driving and even suddenly veering off toward pedestrians or into another lane.

During the call, Tesla acknowledged that its vehicles are largely unaccessible for many people given their high cost and sees the introduction of robotaxi as far the likely to be the first step in the ever expanding market.

“Look at it that a robotaxi is a subsidized ticket,”

Notably, Tesla is considering whether to use lidar and

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Tesla’s full self-driving and Autopilot features have doggedly relied only on cameras and a vision-based approach to reach autonomy, whereas most other AV companies rely on a combination of cameras, radar and lidar. But during the call, Musk admitted to the difficulties of reaching actual full self-driving through this method, which ends up being a constant game of two steps forward, one step back.

“With respect to full self-driving, of any technology development I’ve been involved in, I’ve never really seen more false dawns or where it seems like we’re going to break through, but we don’t, as I’ve seen in

full self-driving,” said Musk. “And ultimately what it comes down to is that to sell full self-driving, you actually have to solve real-world artificial intelligence, which nobody has solved. The whole road system is made for biological neural nets and eyes. And so actually, when you think about it, in order to solve driving, we have to solve neural nets and cameras to a degree of capability that is on par with, or really exceeds humans. And I think we will achieve that this year.”

Topics: [AI](#) [Elon Musk](#) [robotaxi](#) [Tesla](#)

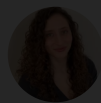
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